

99 per cent of desktop speakers have very low-end amplifier units and low quality parts therefore their sound quality remains mediocre

Ernst W. Siemens was technically the first person to describe and build the first dynamic or moving coil transducer in 1874

TRIED & TESTED

Contact Sheet

Speaker Comparison Test

Contact	Phone	E-mail	Web site
Creative	+91-22-6451 0751	india.getcreative@ctl.creative.com	www.in.creative.com
Altec Lansing	+91-22-6709 0828	response@rptechindia.com	www.rptechindia.com
Zebronic	+91-44-4393 6000	enquiry@zebronic.info	www.zebronic.net
Razer	+91-250-451910	enquiry@netplacetechologies.com	www.razerzone.com
Intex	1-800-116 789	info@intextechnologies.com	www.intextechnologies.com
Logitech	+91-22-2657 1160	kavita_nath@logitech.com	www.logitech.com
Artis	+91-22-6634 5758	sales1@kunhar.com	www.kunhar.com
Audio Engine	+91-22-6635 9109	audioenginesales@gmail.com	www.audioengineusa.com
Umax	+91-22-4085 9600	sales@neoteric.co.in	www.umaxindia.in

cap. The satellite speakers have really solid and cool looking stands made of metal.

Performance:

The most impressive performer from amongst the 2.1 sets was the Umax UPB 3200. Nicknamed "Power Beats", these speakers aren't the most powerful around but they boast of an impressive sound experience. The mid-range is well done — clear and crisp, and most of the finer nuances are well presented and very noticeable.

Guitar and vocal reproduction is good and each string pluck during Eric

Clapton's *Tears In Heaven* is clearly heard and one feels as if the performance is going on in front of him. Female vocals also sound very sharp and precise. The top-end is rolled off, although this is a case with nearly every speaker in this test and this is discernable to the naked ear. The bass is not as strong as we'd ideally like, but it supports the mid-range and highs well and there is an impact to the lows that sounds meaty.

The next speaker that impressed us was the Zebronic Duality 5000. It surpasses its costlier and slightly higher-end sibling in terms of overall detail in the highs. While the Duality 6000 sounded rounded

off, the Duality 5000 was less inclined in this direction. The mid-range also seemed clearer with more detailing. In fact, this set was rather close to another competitor — the identical looking Artis S-Dual. In fact, these speakers were alike in terms of sound signature and both offered great detail. We felt the need for a slightly tighter and more focussed effect to the bass. The Altec Lansing VS2421 was pretty good too — decent bass, a good mid-range and a top-end that felt quite airy and detailed. The speaker that really shocked us with its abysmal performance was the Creative T3100. With its look, we expected so much more, but the bass felt flabby and lifeless and the mid-range was coloured and detail was absent. The highs were also rolled off and post-review we feel you should avoid these speakers at all costs. The Creative M2600 was fairly poor too, as were both the offerings from Logitech and it surprised us to see the bigger brands take such a pounding.

Winners:

Our Best Buy award is meant to reward those products that perform well within



2.1 Speakers

	Zebronic	Artis	Artis	Zebronic	Logitech	Creative	Altec Lansing	Logitech	Creative
	Duality 5000	S222	S-Dual	Duality 6000	X 210	Inspire M2600	VS 2421	X 240	T3100
	Very good sound, Great Looking	Neat looks	Good sound	Looks really neat	Built well	Built well	Neat looking, Good sound	Looks neat, Built well	Good looking
	A little more power required	Poor sound	Slightly expensive	Mediocre Sound	Poor sound	Poor sound	Slightly expensive	Very mediocre sound	Poor sound
	Rs. 1,600	Rs. 1,700	Rs. 2,000	Rs. 2,400	Rs. 2,695	Rs. 2,699	Rs. 3,450	Rs. 3,495	Rs. 3,699
	54.63	36.84	54.18	49.59	36.47	41.52	58.81	40.23	33.82
	13.16	13.44	13.16	17.22	10.50	15.26	20.23	10.43	13.51
	41.47	23.40	41.02	32.37	25.97	26.26	38.58	29.80	20.31
	✓/x/✓	✓/x/✓	✓/x/✓	✓/✓/✓	x/x/✓	✓/x/✓	✓/✓/✓	x/x/✓	✓/x/✓
	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
	x	x	x	x	x	Wired	Wired	Wired	x
	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x	x
	5.5 / 4 / 6.25	5.75 / 4.5 / 6.5	5.5 / 4 / 6.25	6.5 / 5 / 6.25	5.5 / 6.5 / 6.75	5.5 / 5.25 / 6.25	7.5 / 7 / 7.75	5.5 / 6.25 / 6.75	5.5 / 5.25 / 6.25
	6.75	3.5	6.5	4	3	3.75	6	3.5	3.5
	6.25	4	6	4.25	4	4	6.5	3.75	3.5
	6.25	3.88	6.25	5.25	3.75	3.50	5.75	5.00	2.75
	6.25	3.63	6.25	5.88	2.75	2.75	5.88	5.13	2.75
	6.00	3.00	6.00	5.75	5.50	5.25	5.38	5.63	3.13
	6.63	3.88	6.75	5.13	4.88	4.75	6.13	4.63	2.75
	6.38	3.13	6.50	5.75	4.75	4.50	5.50	5.75	3.00